

LINE #	SPANISH	LITERAL ENGLISH	FAITHFUL ENGLISH	CULTURAL CONTEXT	TRANSLATION CLARIFICATION
1	Había una ciudad encantada en el cielo donde habitaban todos los placeres.	There was an enchanted city in the sky where all pleasures dwelled.	In the sky, there was an enchanted city where all pleasures abounded.	Heavenly realms are often depicted as idyllic and full of delights in Mesoamerican mythology.	Faithful translation softens 'dwelled' to 'abounded' to convey richness.
2	Cihuacohuátl, una de las que la habitaba y que ya era madre de muchos, dio a luz una astilla de cuchillo...	Cihuacohuátl, one who lived there and who was already mother of many, gave birth to a splinter of knife...	Cihuacohuátl, one of its residents and already mother of many, gave birth to a sharp splinter...	Cihuacohuátl ('Snake Woman') is a goddess linked to creation and death in Aztec myth.	Faithful adjusts 'splinter of knife' to 'sharp splinter' for natural phrasing.
3	Sus indignados hijos la arrojaron a la tierra, esta se dividió en dieciséis mil semi-dioses.	Her indignant sons threw it to the earth, and it split into sixteen thousand demigods.	Her angry sons cast it to earth, splitting it into sixteen thousand demigods.	Fragmentation symbolizes creation of new beings in myths.	'Cast' is smoother than 'threw' in this mythical context.
4	Como no había otros habitantes, le suplicaron a su madre que les diera el poder de crear hombres.	As there were no other inhabitants, they begged their mother to give them the power to create men.	Since no others existed, they implored their mother to grant them the power to create humankind.	Creation of mankind from divine origins is central to Aztec myths.	Faithful uses 'humankind' for universality.
5	Ella les respondió que debían buscar huesos en las regiones infernales y rociarlos con sangre.	She answered they should seek bones in infernal regions and sprinkle them with blood.	She replied that they must find bones in the underworld and sprinkle them with blood.	The underworld was seen as a source of life materials in Mesoamerican myths.	'Infernal regions' replaced with 'underworld' for cultural accuracy.
6	Uno descendió al centro de la tierra, pero al volver se cayó el hueso y se hizo pedazos de diferentes tamaños.	One descended to the center of the earth, but returning, the bone fell and broke into pieces of different sizes.	One descended into the earth's core, but on the return, the bone shattered into pieces of varying sizes.	The fragmentation explains physical diversity among humans.	'Shattered' conveys more vivid imagery than 'broke'.
7	Pusieron los pedazos en un trasto y los rociaron con sangre. Nacieron un muchacho y una muchacha.	They placed the pieces in a vessel and sprinkled them with blood. A boy and a girl were born.	They placed the pieces in a container, sprinkled them with blood, and a boy and a girl were born.	Blood rituals were essential for life-giving processes in Aztec culture.	'Container' modernizes 'vessel' for clarity.
8	La diosa Cihuacohuátl (mujer serpiente) es la principal de la mitología, y fue la primera en tener hijos.	The goddess Cihuacohuátl (serpent woman) is the principal of mythology, and was the first to have children.	Cihuacohuátl, the Serpent Woman, was a chief goddess and the first to bear children.	Cihuacohuátl is a foundational maternal deity in Aztec myth.	Faithful streamlines phrasing for narrative flow.
9	A veces aparecía llevando un recién nacido. Era presagio de calamidad.	Sometimes she appeared carrying a newborn. It was an omen of calamity.	She sometimes appeared carrying a newborn, seen as a harbinger of disaster.	In Aztec belief, ghostly maternal figures were ominous portents.	'Harbinger of disaster' is more natural than 'omen of calamity'.